

## 6

# Indian National Movement: 1922-29

## EMERGENCE OF SWARAJISTS AND SOCIALIST IDEAS

After the withdrawal of the **Non-Cooperation Movement** in 1922 and **Gandhi's arrest**, Congress leaders faced disarray. The nationalist ranks were divided over the next course of action, leading to the formation of two distinct factions: the **Swarajists** and the **No-Changers**.

**Key Differences Include:**

| Aspect                               | Swarajists                                                                                                                                                                             | No-Changers                                                                                                                                                       |
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| <b>Key Leaders</b>                   | C.R. Das, Motilal Nehru                                                                                                                                                                | C. Rajagopalachari, Vallabhbhai Patel, Rajendra Prasad, M.A. Ansari                                                                                               |
| <b>Formation of Swarajist Party</b>  | Formed on January 1, 1923, after Gaya Congress proposal defeat in 1922. Aimed to enter legislative councils to expose them as "sham parliaments".                                      | Led by Gandhi, insisted on continuing the boycott of legislative councils and focused on the constructive program of social reforms, khadi, and rural upliftment. |
| <b>Main Strategy</b>                 | Participation in the legislative councils to disrupt them if nationalist demands are not met.<br>Slogan: "end or mend".                                                                | Complete boycott of councils. Focus on constructive work (khadi, rural development, and social reforms), preparation for future civil disobedience.               |
| <b>Key Achievements</b>              | Secured electoral victories in councils, passed motions, criticised government policies. Exposed the limitations of the councils.                                                      | Focused on constructive work, maintaining the boycott of councils, rural development programs, khadi, and preparation for future civil disobedience.              |
| <b>Outcome of Efforts</b>            | Initial success, but Swarajist Party faced internal divisions, including communal tensions, leading to a decline after the death of C.R. Das in 1925.                                  | Maintained focus on constructive work and long-term non-violent preparation for mass struggle, limited internal decline.                                          |
| <b>Gandhi's Stance</b>               | Gandhi initially opposed the Swarajists, fearing their entry into the councils would divert attention from mass movements. After the 1923 elections, he supported their participation. | Gandhi led the No-Changers, believing in the importance of maintaining the boycott. Eventually reconciled with Swarajists at the Belgaum Congress in 1924.        |
| <b>Challenges Faced</b>              | Faced challenges like internal divisions, inability to form coalitions, failure to fully maintain the nationalist platform, and communal tensions.                                     | Faced challenges in maintaining the boycott and commitment to the constructive program but avoided participation in councils.                                     |
| <b>Swarajist Legislative Actions</b> | Swarajists disrupted the councils, passed resolutions for self-government, demanded civil liberties, and exposed British repressive policies.                                          | No-Changers avoided participation in legislative councils, focusing instead on constructive programs and future civil disobedience movements.                     |

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| <b>Stand on Constructive Work</b> | The Swarajists criticised the No-Changers' Constructive Work for being too gradual. While acknowledging efforts in khadi, education, and Hindu-Muslim unity, they believed it lacked immediate impact on British rule. They favoured civil disobedience and non-cooperation over constructive efforts, arguing these were more effective in pressuring the British government for Swaraj. | The No-Changers focused on social reforms, establishing ashrams in Kheda and Bardoli (Gujarat) to promote khadi, charkha, and uplift tribals and lower castes. They worked on Hindu-Muslim unity, untouchability eradication, and boycotting foreign goods. Key initiatives included promoting self-reliance, supporting the Khilafat Movement, establishing national schools and colleges, and providing flood relief, forming the backbone of the Civil Disobedience Movement. |
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## EMERGENCE OF NEW FORCES IN 1920s

**Origins of the Left Movement in India:** The growth of the Left movement was influenced by several key factors:

- **Development of Indian Industries:** Economic advancements prompted the rise of new political ideas.
- **Economic Stress from World War I:** The war exacerbated existing economic hardships.
- **Success of the Bolshevik Revolution:** Inspired young nationalists to seek radical solutions to India's socio-political challenges.

### Key Figures and Contributions

- **M.N. Roy:** A pivotal figure in introducing communist ideas to India; he founded the Communist Party of India (CPI) in 1920.
- **Jawaharlal Nehru and Subhash Chandra Bose:** Influential leaders within Congress's left wing, shaped by socialist thought.
- **S.A. Dange:** Involved in the Kanpur Bolshevik Conspiracy Case of 1924, contributing to the spread of communist ideas.

### Communist Party of India (CPI)

- **Foundation:** The CPI was formally established at the Indian Communist Conference in Kanpur in 1925. Despite facing government crackdowns, such as the Meerut Conspiracy Case of 1929, the CPI aligned with Congress, promoting Marxist ideas and strengthening its left-wing presence.

### The Left Movements in India

**Communism in India:** Communist ideologies gained traction post-Russian Revolution, with the CPI's establishment in 1925 marking organised communist efforts in India.

- **Evolution:** The CPI faced internal splits, leading to factions like CPI(M).

### Congress Socialist Party (CSP)

- **Foundation:** Established on May 17, 1934, in Patna, with Acharya Narendra Dev as president. Supported cooperative economies, independent farmers, and local

governance while opposing the dictatorship of the proletariat. The CSP pushed for radical measures within Congress, including the removal of middlemen and cancellation of peasants' debts. After independence, the CSP struggled to redefine its role, eventually dissolving as Congress adopted a socialist agenda under Nehru.

### The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP)

- **Origins and Development:** Established in 1940 within the Bengali socialist movement, the RSP criticised both Soviet-style socialism and the Gandhian approach. Active primarily in West Bengal and Kerala, the RSP focused on working-class rights, opposing both capitalist and Stalinist models. Although it faced limited electoral success, it influenced leftist policy debates.

### The Emergence of Youth Activism in the Indian Freedom Struggle

Youth played a crucial role in India's independence movement, bringing energy and vision that shaped its trajectory.

- **Organisational Platforms:** In the late 1920s and 1930s, youths established **student leagues** and political wings for idea exchange and strategizing.
- **1928 Significance:** Jawaharlal Nehru's presidency at the **All Bengal Students' Conference** symbolised the union of seasoned wisdom and youthful vigour.
- **Active Participation:** Young activists engaged in **boycotts, protests, and non-violent resistance**, reaching into rural areas.
- **Literary Influence:** They produced and circulated **pamphlets** and **underground newsletters** that envisioned a liberated India.
- **Colonial Repression:** The British used **arrests** and **expulsions** to stifle youth influence, but such tactics only fueled their resistance.

### Growth of Trade Unionism in the Early 20th Century

**Formation of AITUC:** All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) was established in 1920 under **Lala Lajpat Rai** in Bombay, creating a national platform for workers across various industries to advocate for their rights and justice.

## Notable Strikes and Agitations

- **Kharagpur Railway Workshops:** Early strike against poor working conditions and unfair wages.
- **Tata Iron and Steel Works:** Workers protested discriminatory wages and working conditions.
- **Bombay Textile Mills:** Major unrest occurred, with mill workers demanding better wages, working hours, and safe environments.

**Milestone: Celebration of May Day:** The first May Day was celebrated in **Madras in 1923**, symbolising international worker solidarity and highlighting workers' rights.

## Caste Movements

Caste movements in early 20th-century India emerged as significant socio-political forces, addressing various societal contradictions and aspirations for social improvement.

- **Self-Respect Movement (1925):** Led by **E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker (Periyar)**, focused on non-Brahmin and Dravidian equality, challenging Brahmin dominance and irrational customs.
- **Satyashodhak Samaj:** Founded by **Jyotirao Phule** in the 19th century, promoted lower caste rights and education.
- **Justice Party (1916):** Non-Brahmin elites in **Madras Presidency**, sought political and job reservations.
- **All India Non-Brahmin Conference:** Demanded communal representation for non-Brahmins.
- **Mahars Movement:** Led by **B.R. Ambedkar**, focused on uplifting the Mahar community.
- **Radical Ezhavas Movement:** Led by **K. Aiyappan**, aimed at improving Ezhava community status.
- **Yadav's Movement:** Focused on improving the Yadav community's status in **Bihar**.

## State's Peoples' Conference Movements (Praja Mandal Movements)

The **Praja Mandal Movements** emerged in the early 20th century as a significant aspect of the national movement in India, particularly within the princely states. Following the **Non-Cooperation Movement** of 1920, these movements facilitated the establishment of people's organisations aimed at advocating for democratic rights and addressing the grievances of subjects under feudal rule.

- **Anti-Feudal and Anti-Colonial:** The movements aimed to combat both feudal princes and the British administration, demanding democratic rights for the subjects of princely states.

- **Focus on Democratic Rights:** The primary demand of the Praja Mandal movements was the establishment of democratic rights and governance.

## Key Organisations within the National Movement

1. **Hitvardhak Sabha Founded:** May 1921 in Poona. Addressed issues facing the people of the southern princely states.
2. **Akhil Bhore Sansthan Praja Sabha Founded:** November 1921 by Wamanrao Patwardhan in the Bhore region. Tackled local problems affecting the Bhore populace.
3. **All India Association of the People's Council:** The Bombay session in 1927 transformed the princely state's national movement into a nationwide cause. Responsible governance and rights for the citizens of princely states.
4. **Congress's Role:** The Indian National Congress supported the movement, endorsing its demands during the Madras Session and integrating it with the national struggle against British rule.

## Congress's Contribution to the Praja Mandal Movement

- The Congress Party's policies and programs, particularly those of the **Gandhian Movement**, provided a boost to the Praja Mandal movement.
- **State People's Conference:** In Orissa, the Congress leaders organised a conference in 1937 to address the conditions in princely states, reconstituted in 1938 under H.K. Mahatab.
- The establishment of a Congress ministry in Orissa in July 1937 inspired further activism against despotic rulers.

## REVOLUTIONARY ACTIVITIES IN THE 1920s

### Major Influences Driving Revolutionary Activity

- **Impact of the Russian Revolution (1917):** The establishment of the Soviet state inspired Indian revolutionaries, infusing Marxist and socialist ideologies into their struggles.
- **Emergence of Communist Groups:** New communist organisations began promoting Marxism and emphasising the role of the proletariat in revolution.
- **Role of Publications:** Journals such as **Atmasakti**, **Sarathi**, and **Bijoli**, along with banned literature like **Bandi Jiwan** by Sachin Sanyal and **Pather Dabi** by Sharatchandra Chatterjee, glorified revolutionary sacrifices and spread socialist ideas.

**Note:** Phase -I of Revolutionary Activities (1907-17) has been covered in Chapter 4 in detail.

## Revolutionary Activities (Phase -II in 1920s)

| Case/Organization (Year and Place)                                                                                                          | Associated People and Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| <b>Hindustan Republican Association (HRA)/ Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)</b><br>(1924, Punjab, United Provinces, Bihar) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Founded in <b>Kanpur</b> by <b>Ramprasad Bismil</b>, <b>Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee</b>, and <b>Sachin Sanyal</b>.</li> <li>The aim was to overthrow the colonial government through armed revolution and establish a <b>Federal Republic of the United States of India</b>.</li> <li>It was reorganised as <b>HSRA</b> in September 1928 under the leadership of <b>Chandrashekhar Azad</b>, reflecting an ideological shift toward <b>socialist ideas</b>.</li> <li>Key participants included <b>Bhagat Singh</b>, <b>Sukhdev</b>, <b>Bhagwaticharan Vohra</b> (from <b>Punjab</b>), and <b>Bejoy Kumar Sinha</b>, <b>Shiv Verma</b>, <b>Jaidev Kapur</b> (from <b>United Provinces</b>).</li> <li>Geographical Focus: Active in <b>Punjab</b>, <b>Uttar Pradesh</b>, and <b>Bihar</b>.</li> <li>Shift to <b>Socialism</b>: Initially formed to overthrow British colonial rule, the <b>HRA</b> rebranded itself as <b>HSRA</b> in 1928, reflecting a shift towards <b>socialism</b>.</li> <li>Under leaders like <b>Chandrashekhar Azad</b>, <b>Ram Prasad Bismil</b>, and <b>Bhagat Singh</b>, the <b>HSRA</b> continued revolutionary activities while advocating for a <b>socialist vision</b> for post-independence India.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Kakori Robbery</b><br>(1925, Kakori, near Lucknow)                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Action by <b>HRA</b> revolutionaries who looted the 8-Down train at <b>Kakori railway station</b> near <b>Lucknow</b>.</li> <li>This led to the arrest of several revolutionaries, with key figures <b>Bismil</b>, <b>Ashfaqullah</b>, <b>Roshan Singh</b>, and <b>Rajendra Lahiri</b> executed.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Saunders' Murder</b><br>(December 1928, Lahore)                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>Bhagat Singh</b>, <b>Chandrashekhar Azad</b>, and <b>Rajguru</b> shot dead <b>Saunders</b>, a police official responsible for the lathicharge in <b>Lahore</b> that led to the death of <b>Lala Lajpat Rai</b>.</li> <li>Retaliation for <b>Lala Lajpat Rai's</b> death during an anti-Simon Commission protest. <b>Bhagat Singh</b> and <b>Rajguru</b> mistakenly assassinated <b>John P. Saunders</b> instead of their intended target <b>James Scott</b>.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Bombing of Central Legislative Assembly</b> (April 1929, Delhi)                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>Bhagat Singh</b> and <b>Batukeshwar Dutt</b> bombed the <b>Central Legislative Assembly</b> in protest against the <b>Public Safety Bill</b> and the <b>Trade Disputes Bill</b>. The bombing was intended as a statement rather than to cause harm. The duo aimed to use the trial as an opportunity to spread revolutionary ideology.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Meerut Conspiracy Case</b><br>(1929, Meerut)                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Various <b>labour leaders</b> and three <b>Englishmen</b> were accused of conspiring to organise a railway strike. The accused received various sentences, leading to widespread protest and increasing British concern over <b>communist influences</b> in India.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Kanpur Conspiracy Case</b><br>(1924, Kanpur)                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Main accused: <b>Muzaffar Ahmed</b>, <b>Shaukat Usmani</b>, <b>Nalini Gupta</b>, <b>S.A. Dange</b>, <b>Gopal Basak</b>. The accused were sentenced to <b>rigorous imprisonment</b>, reflecting the growing influence of <b>communist ideology</b> in the Indian freedom movement.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Ghadar Conspiracy</b><br>(1915, Worldwide/India)                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Led by <b>Har Dayal</b>, <b>Raghubir Singh</b>, and others.</li> <li>Conspired to initiate an <b>armed revolt</b>.</li> <li>Many conspirators were executed or imprisoned. The conspiracy mobilised the <b>Indian diaspora</b>, underscoring the international aspect of the freedom movement.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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| <b>Berar Conspiracy Case</b><br>(1916, Berar)                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <b>R.S. Nimbkar</b> and others were involved in inciting an <b>armed rebellion</b>.</li> <li>• The accused received various sentences, broadening the reach of the freedom movement and inspiring others to join the cause.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Bombay Conspiracy Case</b><br>(1917, Bombay)                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Key figures: <b>V.N. Chatterjee, Joseph Baptista</b>, and others.</li> <li>• The case involved <b>sedition</b> and <b>incitement to warfare</b>. The imprisonment of the accused led to increased urban discontent and highlighted the role of <b>educated Indians</b> in the freedom struggle.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Peshawar Conspiracy Cases</b><br>(1922-1927, Peshawar)              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Various <b>Pashtun leaders</b> were involved in <b>anti-British activities</b> and conspiracies. The harsh sentences, including <b>transportation for life</b>, galvanised support for <b>non-cooperation</b>, especially in the <b>North-West Frontier Province</b>.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Chittagong Armoury Raid</b><br>(April 1930, Bengal)                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Organised by <b>Surya Sen</b> with associates: <b>Anant Singh, Ganesh Ghosh</b>, and <b>Lokenath Baul</b>.</li> <li>• The raid aimed to show that it was possible to challenge the <b>armed might of the British Empire</b>. Although the raid did not achieve its immediate goals, it became a powerful <b>symbol of resistance</b> and demonstrated a commitment to <b>social justice</b> alongside political freedom.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Murder of Michael O'Dwyer</b> (March 13, 1940, Caxton Hall, London) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <b>Udham Singh</b> assassinated <b>Michael O'Dwyer</b>, the former Lieutenant Governor of Punjab, at <b>Caxton Hall in London</b>.</li> <li>• <b>O'Dwyer</b> was responsible for the <b>Jallianwala Bagh massacre</b> (1919), in which <b>Udham Singh</b> had survived.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                  |

## Revolutionary Activities in Bengal (1920s-1930s)

- Revolutionary groups reorganised underground networks while some operated under Congress, gaining access to the masses.
- Collaboration with C.R. Das strengthened the Swarajist agenda.
- Post-Das's death (1925), Bengal Congress split: J.M. Sengupta faction (backed by Anushilan) & Subhash Bose faction (supported by Yugantar).
- Role of Surya Sen: Also a poet and admirer of Tagore and Qazi Nazrul Islam, seize Chittagong's main armouries, disrupt railway, telephone, and telegraph systems & proclaim a provisional revolutionary government; execution conducted by 65 members under the Indian Republican Army – Chittagong Branch; got arrested (1933) & hanged in 1934.
- Role of Women in the Movement:
  - **Pritilata Waddedar**: Died in action during a raid.
  - **Kalpana Dutt**: Arrested, tried with Surya Sen, and sentenced to life.
  - **Santi Ghosh and Suniti Chandheri**: Assassinated a district magistrate (1931).
  - **Bina Das**: Attempted to assassinate the Bengal governor (1932).
- **Group Action**: Targeted colonial structures rather than individuals, inspiring youth and demoralizing the British bureaucracy.

- **Inclusivity**: Abandoned Hindu rituals, facilitating Muslim participation (Satar, Mir Ahmed, Fakir Ahmed Mian, Tunu Mian).
- **Drawbacks**: retained some conservative elements and failed to develop broader socio-economic goals & Swarajists did not support Muslim peasantry against zamindars in Bengal.

**Action Against the Revolutionaries**: Revolutionaries like **Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev**, and **Rajguru** were tried in the **Lahore Conspiracy Case**. Imprisoned, they protested poor conditions through **hunger strikes**, demanding political prisoner status. **Jatin Das** became the first martyr, dying after 64 days on hunger strike. **Azad** died in a police encounter in **Allahabad** (February 1931), while on **March 23, 1931**, **Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev**, and **Rajguru** were executed by hanging.

### Contribution of Bhagat Singh:

- **Born (1907)**: Well-read political leader.
- **Revolutionary Ideology**: Shifted from terrorism to **Marxism**, focused on **abolition of exploitation** (**HRA Manifesto, 1925**).
- **Political Organisations**:
  - **Punjab Naujawan Bharat Sabha (1926)**: Engaged youth/workers, promoted **secularism**, **religious toleration**.
  - **Lahore Students Union**: Legal political engagement for students.

- **Opposition to Communalism:** Advocated for national unity, separation of religion from politics.
- **Critique of Religion:** “Why I Am an Atheist”, rejected religion and superstition.

### SIMON COMMISSION (1927)

- **Established:** November 8, 1927, to review India's progress post **Government of India Act, 1919**.
- **Leadership:** Sir John Simon, Clement Attlee, Sir Harry Levy-Lawson, Sir Edward Cecil George Cadogan, Vernon Hartshorn, George Richard Lane-Fox, Donald Sterling Palmer Howard.
- **Objective:** Assess India's readiness for reforms, recommend changes to the British government.
- **Political Context:** Conservative government aimed to act before a **Labour Party** victory.

### Indian Response

- **Exclusion of Indians:** No Indian representation, viewed as undemocratic. [UPSC 2013]
- **Congress Boycott:** December 1927 in Madras, led by M.A. Ansari and Jawaharlal Nehru, demanding complete independence.
- **Protests:** February 3, 1928, arrival in Bombay, sparking hartals, rallies, and protests across Calcutta, Lahore, Madras, Lucknow, with the slogan “Simon Go Back.”
- **Police Violence:** Lala Lajpat Rai injured in October 1928 protests, leading to Bhagat Singh's assassination of Saunders.
- **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar:** Advocated for Universal Adult Franchise and protections for depressed classes.

### Simon Commission Recommendations (1930)

- **Provincial Reforms:** Abolish dyarchy, increase legislative councils, grant provincial autonomy, governors' discretionary powers on security.
- **Central Governance:** Reject parliamentary responsibility, strengthen Governor-General's authority, retain central control over high courts.
- **Communal Electorates:** Extend separate communal electorates.
- **Federalism:** Gradual federalism, Consultative Council of Greater India.
- **Local Legislatures:** For North-West Frontier Province and Baluchistan, represented at the centre.
- **Separation:** Sindh from Bombay, Burma from India.
- **Military:** Indianization of the army, retain British forces.

### NEHRU REPORT (1928)

**Birkenhead's Challenge:** Lord Birkenhead called for a unified constitutional proposal, encouraging Indian unity.

- **Initiative:** February 1928, All Parties Conference appointed a subcommittee led by **Motilal Nehru** to draft a constitution.
- **Committee Members:** Tej Bahadur Sapru, Subhas Chandra Bose, M.S. Aney, Mangal Singh, Ali Imam, Shuaib Qureshi, G.R. Pradhan.
- **Finalised:** August 1928.

### Key Recommendations

[UPSC 2011]

- **Dominion Status:** Proposed **dominion status** akin to self-governing dominions within the **British Empire**
- **Electoral System:** Rejected separate electorates, advocated for **joint electorate** with **reserved seats** for minorities (excluding areas like **Punjab** and **Bengal** where they constituted a majority).
- **Provincial Reforms:** Suggested establishment of **linguistic provinces**
- **Fundamental Rights:** Proposed **19 fundamental rights**, including **Equal rights for women**, **Right to form unions**, **Universal adult suffrage**, etc.
- **System of Governance:**
  - **Indian Parliament:** **House of Representatives** (500 members, elected through adult suffrage, 5-year term). **Senate** (200 members, elected by provincial councils, 7-year term).
  - **Governor-General:** Appointed by the British government, paid from **Indian revenues**, worked with the central executive council responsible to the Parliament.
  - **Provincial Councils:** Headed by a **governor**, acting on advice of **provincial executive councils**.
- **Protection of Muslim Interests:** Ensured full protection of **Muslim cultural and religious interests**.
- **Secular State:** Advocated for **complete separation of the state from religion**.

### Context and Significance

- **Congress:** Set a **two-year** deadline for dominion status, later reduced to one year, threatening **civil disobedience** if unmet. **Independence for India League:** Established by Nehru and Bose.
- **December 1929, Lahore Session of Congress:** Adopted **Complete Independence** resolution.
- **Nehru's Tricolour Hoisting:** Symbolised commitment to independence at midnight on **December 31, 1929**.
- Despite limitations, the **Nehru Report** laid the groundwork for future **discussions on Indian governance and constitutional reform**.

## Communal Responses of Muslims and Hindus

### Delhi Proposals (1927)

- **Formulation:** Muslim League, December 1927.
- **Joint Electorates:** Replace separate electorates with joint, reserving seats for Muslims.
- **Representation in Central Assembly:** One-third representation for Muslims.
- **Proportional Representation:** In Punjab and Bengal.
- **New Provinces:** Creation of Sindh, Balochistan, and North-West Frontier Province as Muslim-majority provinces.

**Hindu Mahasabha Response: Opposition:** Against new Muslim-majority provinces and reserved seats in Punjab and Bengal. Advocated for a unitary political structure, complicating communal negotiations. **Younger Nationalists' Discontent:** Jawaharlal Nehru and Subhash Bose dissatisfied with the Nehru Report's dominion status, advocating for Complete Independence.

### Jinnah's Amendments And Fourteen Points (1928-1929)

#### Amendments in Nehru Report (1928)

- **One-third Representation** for Muslims in the central legislature.
- **Reservations** for Muslims in Bengal and Punjab legislatures based on population until adult suffrage.
- **Residual powers** for provinces.

### Jinnah's Fourteen Points (March 1929)

- **Federal constitution** with provincial residual powers.
- **Provincial autonomy** and no constitutional amendments without state concurrence.
- **Muslim representation** in all legislatures and elected bodies, ensuring no Muslim-majority provinces turned into minorities.
- **Muslim representation** in services and self-governing bodies.
- **One-third representation** for Muslims in the central legislature and any cabinet.
- **Separate electorates** for Muslims.
- **Veto power** for minorities: No bill passed if three-fourths of a minority opposes it.
- **Territorial redistribution:** Protect Muslim majorities in Punjab, Bengal, and NWFP.
- **Separation of Sindh** from Bombay.
- **Constitutional reforms** in NWFP and Balochistan.
- **Religious freedom** guaranteed to all communities.
- **Protection of Muslim rights:** Religion, culture, education, language.

#### Rejection of Nehru Report:

Rejected by Muslim League, Hindu Mahasabha, Sikh communalists, and younger Congress members due to dissatisfaction with dominion status. Contributed to the formation of the Independence for India League by Nehru and Bose.

